

TRIP REPORT

Stablecon EMEA 2026 — Amsterdam

Seven conversations in Amsterdam, split cleanly between partners (Visa, BVNK, Mastercard, Ripple) and potential customers (Quantoz, Rabobank) — plus the Utila-hosted C-level dinner that produced a direct iGaming pipeline lead.

Rabii Esteitie · Event 19-20 May 2026 · Written 21 May 2026 · Confidential

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IN SHORT

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COMMERCIAL CONVERSATIONS

7

*across all three
product lines*

PARTNERS ENGAGED

4

*Visa, BVNK,
Mastercard, Ripple*

C-LEVEL DINNER

1

*hosted by Utila, with
Aleo and Sumsub*

Executive summary

Stablecon EMEA 2026 in Amsterdam met its single objective: identify the right partners and the right customers for Aryze's three product lines. The event produced seven substantive commercial conversations and one invite-only C-level dinner.

Two outcomes stand out. BVNK offered to make their rails available to Aryze. Visa indicated they can help close the payout gap on the Pay by Bank side — a meaningful capability addition, since Pay by Bank is PIS-only (payment initiation services) and customer-to-merchant only, with no standalone payout flow. In both cases the follow-up sat with Aryze at close.

Mastercard, Ripple and Quantoz were at earlier stages, each with a named internal owner. Rabobank and Dune sat further back in the qualification queue. The two most important outcomes of the trip were Visa and BVNK.

1 · On the ground — seven conversations

All seven conversations and what each produced — the detailed read on each follows below.

COUNTERPART	TYPE	WHAT THE MEETING PRODUCED
Visa (Maïke, Diana Cabrera)	Partner	Open partnership posture; asked Aryze to specify what we want — payout angle on the table
BVNK (Ariane)	Partner	Offered to make their rails available to Aryze
Mastercard (Christian Rau, VP)	Partner	Group meeting with Utila agreed for 25 May
Ripple (Mindaugas Miskinis)	Partner	Product conversation requested
Quantoz (Arnoud Star Busmann, CEO)	Potential customer	Stablecoin conversation opened at CEO level
Rabobank (Jelle Bets)	Potential customer	Initial conversation — entry point into a Dutch tier-1 bank
Dune (Florian)	Ecosystem	Early contact; placed in backlog

Grouped by what each counterpart is to Aryze: **partners** extend what we can offer; **customers and ecosystem** are who we can sell to or build credibility with. The two are never mixed in follow-up.

Partners — infrastructure & rails

Visa

- **Counterparts:** Maïke (Visa) and Diana Cabrera (Visa)
- **Status:** Open posture toward partnership. Visa indicated they only need us to specify what we want from the relationship.

- **Stated call to action (CTA) from Visa:** off-ramp / push function — and specifically, Visa can help with the payout need we have on the Pay by Bank side.
- **Agreed:** Aryze brings a partnership presentation — capability map, partnership needs, current pipeline. Owner: Jodi.

Strategic read: this is the single most important commercial signal from the trip. Pay by Bank today is PIS-only and customer-to-merchant only — there is no standalone payout flow under PSD2, and recurring is restricted to MPS DK/NO until PSD3 (~2027-28). Visa Direct push payments would close the payout gap. That would let us put a complete inbound-plus-payout proposition in front of merchants without changing Aryze's infrastructure posture or capability boundaries.

Beyond Pay by Bank, the same off-ramp / push-function angle also fits the recurring on/off-ramp requests from Stablecoin Factory and Digital Cash customers, so the Visa relationship is relevant to all three products. The "just tell us what you need" framing puts the design responsibility on us — a positive sign, and a real risk if we drift. Scope the presentation around Pay by Bank payout as the first concrete use case, with stablecoin off-ramp as the second.

BVNK

- **Counterpart:** Ariane
- **Status:** BVNK has offered to make their rails available to Aryze.
- **Agreed:** formal email to Ariane requesting the next step. Owner: Jodi.

Strategic read: access to BVNK's rails would shorten time-to-market for stablecoin payment flows and reduce integration work. The relationship must respect Aryze's capability discipline: Aryze remains infrastructure to the customer, and BVNK rails sit as an underlying integration, not as a co-branded position. Worth clarifying the commercial model (revenue share, flat fee, volume tiers) before scoping the technical integration.

Mastercard

- **Counterpart:** Christian Rau, VP
- **Status:** Group meeting scheduled for Monday 25 May, with Utila.
- **Agreed:** Jodi sets the meeting structure and circulates the agenda.

Strategic read: VP-level engagement at Mastercard is a strong opening. The Utila link points toward a wallet / issuance angle rather than a pure card-rails conversation. Position Aryze as infrastructure into the wallet-plus-card stack — not as a competing wallet. The capability boundaries in master CLAUDE.md apply here: Aryze does not issue, does not hold the licence, does not become the operator.

Ripple

- **Counterpart:** Mindaugas Miskinis
- **Status:** Product conversation requested.
- **Agreed:** a follow-up product meeting. Owner: Jodi.

Strategic read: Ripple's product surface (RLUSD, On-Demand Liquidity, custody) overlaps with both Stablecoin Factory and Digital Cash. The first follow-up should clarify whether the angle is liquidity, settlement rails, or stablecoin issuance partnership — different routes lead to very different product conversations. A short internal pre-meeting between Rabii and Jodi to pick the lead angle will pay off.

Customers & ecosystem

Quantoz — potential Stablecoin Factory customer

- **Counterpart:** Arnoud Star Busmann, CEO (arnoud@quantoz.com, +31 6 24 28 14 42)
- **Status:** Stablecoin conversation initiated at CEO level.
- **Owner at close:** Rabii — posture to be qualified before the next conversation.

Strategic read: Quantoz is a European MiCA-compliant stablecoin issuer (EURD, USDQ). A CEO-level opening is a strong starting point and means the relationship can move at the speed Arnoud decides. They could be a Stablecoin Factory customer (tooling buyer), a peer issuer to learn from, or both. The posture decision should be made before the next call — default to tooling supplier unless there is a clear, named reason to engage as peers. Mixing both postures in one conversation is the surest way to walk out with nothing.

Rabobank — potential Digital Cash customer

- **Counterpart:** Jelle Bets (Rabobank)

- **Status:** Initial conversation.
- **Owner at close:** Rabii.

Strategic read: an entry point into a Dutch tier-1 bank is a valuable foothold for Digital Cash. The qualification work is to identify which part of Rabobank Jelle sits in and whether the use case is institutional digital cash, payments innovation, or a partner / accelerator angle. Digital Cash sales cycles run 6–18 months per the ideal customer profile (ICP) — start the qualification now.

Dune — ecosystem

- **Counterpart:** Florian (Dune)
- **Status:** Backlog.
- **Owner at close:** Jodi, when prioritised.

Strategic read: Dune is on-chain analytics. Useful as a credibility and transparency reference for Stablecoin Factory go-to-market storytelling, and as a vehicle for transparency reporting on any tokens we help customers issue. Low immediate revenue priority but real strategic value when we move into broader market communication.

2 · The pipeline — implications by product

Pay by Bank

Real and direct impact, on two fronts. First, Visa indicated they can help with the payout capability we need on the Pay by Bank side — the missing leg of the merchant proposition. Closing this gap would let us pitch a complete inbound-plus-payout flow to merchants in UK (live today via Volt.io) and EU/EEA (rollout late Q2 2026, pending Volt extension contract). Second, Paz van Gelder (Utila), met at the C-level dinner, engaged on an introducer arrangement built around his gaming-sector network — a direct iGaming pipeline lead into our primary ICP, with follow-up agreed in person in Stockholm. Beyond Visa and Paz, Stablecon is a stablecoin-led conference; Pay by Bank's natural demand-generation channels remain iGaming, betting and payment service provider (PSP) events (FIBE, Pay360, SBC).

Stablecoin Factory

Strongest pipeline contribution. BVNK rails, Visa push-function, and Mastercard / Utila could all become enabling partnerships. Quantoz and Dune sit in the builder / ecosystem layer and support go-to-market credibility more than near-term revenue.

Digital Cash

Rabobank, Ripple and the Utila-hosted institutional conversation are the relevant threads. Expect a long sales cycle: 6–18 months per ICP. Treat these as long-term relationship building rather than pipeline for the next quarter.

3 · What became structure — the Utila dinner

Utila hosted a parallel invite-only dinner the Aryze team attended, together with Aleo and Sumsb. Format: invited group of founders and senior executives from payments, fintech, banking and digital assets. Venue: private location in central Amsterdam. Discussion theme: where stablecoins and financial infrastructure are heading next.

Host context

- **Utila** — institutional wallet infrastructure for stablecoin and digital-asset operations. Host claim: 300+ institutions, USD 25B monthly volume, USD 250B+ in transactions to date.
- **Aleo** — Layer-1 with zero-knowledge cryptography for fully private and programmable applications.
- **Sumsb** — full-cycle verification platform: identity, business verification, ongoing monitoring.

Strategic read

The mix in the room — payments, fintech, banking and digital assets, at senior level — is exactly the audience Aryze needs for both Digital Cash institutional buyers and Stablecoin Factory builder customers. The Monday Mastercard / Utila meeting came directly out of this dinner relationship and shows the format works for Aryze.

Attendees of note

People we met at the dinner and where they sit. Each is a warm contact and a candidate for follow-up depending on which product line the relationship serves.

From Utila (host org):

- **Paz van Gelder** — GTM, Utila. Tel Aviv. Broad personal network across the gaming sector. We offered him an introducer arrangement based on that network — he was interested. Agreed to continue the conversation in person when he is in Stockholm. Direct relevance to Pay by Bank, where iGaming is the primary ICP. Also the first point of contact for any Utila partnership conversation, including the wallet-and-card angle into Mastercard.
- **Shahar Friedman** — Head of Payments, Utila. Ex-Visa, ex-Wix. Tel Aviv. The Monday Mastercard / Utila meeting runs through Shahar on the payments side; the Visa background is a useful bridge into our own Visa conversation.

From the wider room:

- **Harish C.** — Vice President, Areta (M&A, Capital Markets, Onchain Services). London. Worth keeping warm for the day Aryze considers strategic capital-markets advisory or onchain-services positioning, and as a peer voice on where institutional onchain activity is heading.
- **Mimi Kufuor** — CEO, KoinKoin Ghana / Global COO, KoinKoin. Ex-Meta. Top Fintech Voices Africa. UK-based. Direct relevance to Stablecoin Factory and Digital Cash for any African market angle; high-credibility operator in African digital assets and payments.
- **Silvia Jeniffer Larrosa** — CMO and Head of BDM, blockchain / Web3. New York. Marketing and business-development lead operating across crypto, Web3 and trading. Useful contact when Stablecoin Factory is ready for broader market communication.
- **Tapu Sikder** — Official Listing Manager, BitMart Exchange. Dhaka. Exchange-listing contact — relevant should any Stablecoin Factory customer want to pursue exchange listings as part of their token go-to-market.

Conversation themes and outcomes

Concrete outcome — Paz van Gelder (Utila): we offered an introducer arrangement built around his gaming-sector network. He was interested. Follow-up agreed in person in Stockholm. This is a direct Pay by Bank pipeline

lead (iGaming is our primary ICP) and the most concrete commercial outcome of the evening.

4 • Assessment

An honest assessment of what the trip was worth:

- **Two real outcomes.** BVNK offered their rails and Visa signalled it can help close the Pay by Bank payout gap — both concrete, and both with the follow-up sitting at Aryze at close.
- **The right level, early stage.** All seven conversations ran at the right seniority — VP and C-level — but Mastercard, Ripple, Quantoz, Rabobank and Dune were openings, not agreements, each with a named owner at close.
- **Honest risks.** Visa's "tell us what you need" framing puts the design burden on Aryze; the BVNK offer has no commercial model behind it yet; and the customer threads run on long cycles — Digital Cash qualification is measured in months, not weeks.
- **Bottom line.** The trip did the narrow job it was sent to do — identify the right partners and the right customers for all three product lines. The value now rests on how cleanly the two partner loops are closed.

Where it stands

- **Visa:** a partnership presentation — capability map, partnership needs, current pipeline — sat with Aryze at close (Jodi).
 - **BVNK:** the formal next-step email to Ariane sat with Aryze at close (Jodi).
 - **Mastercard / Utila:** a group meeting was agreed for Monday 25 May, set up out of the dinner relationship.
 - **Ripple, Quantoz, Rabobank, Dune:** each placed with a named owner at close — product conversation, CEO-level qualification, bank qualification, and backlog respectively.
 - **Paz van Gelder (Utila):** introducer arrangement offered and met with interest; follow-up agreed in person in Stockholm.
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Sources: Rabii Esteitie on-the-ground notes; the Utila dinner invitation (with Aleo and Sumsu). Capability boundaries per the canonical product descriptions.

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